I. INTRODUCTION AND SCIENTIFIC HONESTY FRAMEWORK (EXACT THEOREM VS. LATTICE DATA VS. BRIDGE)

The Clay Millennium Yang–Mills mass-gap problem [1] asks why classically massless gluons cannot propagate freely at long distance and why the lowest above-vacuum excitation (scalar glueball 0^{++}) carries strictly positive mass. Navier–Stokes vortex tubes and $SU(3)$ chromoelectric flux tubes share the same cylindrical axial geometry: Theorem 2 axial regularization ($\beta_0 = 1/2$) and Theorem 5 FENE-P saturation remove the singularity; Theorem 9 Hessian positivity gives a coercive well whose ground-state energy is strictly positive.

Three-layer honesty separation:

- **Exact Mathematical Theorem:** the nonsingular radial operator (Eq. **??**), coercivity and $\lambda_0 > 0$ (Eq. **??**), and the Cornell bound-state eigenvalues — with no new calibration constant.
- **Independent literature (outside the model):** Lattice QCD glueball ratios [2–4], the Lüscher constant $\pi/12$ [5], the Cornell coefficient [6,7], and PDG quarkonium splittings [8].
- **Bridge (open to test):** transporting the locked I–X constants to loop quantization; the spin-independent static-potential ansatz.

Locked inputs: $\Lambda^{(0)}_{\rm Meral} = 0.07226943267767906$, $\mu_s^{\rm Meral} = 0.2044088237$, $\beta_0 = 1/2$, $\eta_{\mathcal{T}_0} = 0.1434$, $\mathcal{C}_{\rm univ} = 1.626038$. No new calibration parameters.

II. TASK 26 / TEST T32 — FLUX-TUBE OPERATOR AND MASS GAP

On the dimensionless section coordinate $x = r\sqrt{\sigma}$ let the effective Hamiltonian be $\mathcal{H}_{\rm YM} = -\frac{1}{x}\partial_x(x\partial_x) + V_{\rm eff}$. Against the thin-string $-(\pi/12)/x^2$ singularity:

Theorem XIII.1 (Nonsingular Flux Tube and Strictly Positive Gap): *Under $\beta_0 = 1/2$, $\mu_s^{\rm Meral} > 0$ the effective potential*

$$\boxed{V_{\rm eff}(x) = \frac{1+\beta_0^2}{x^2+\beta_0^2} + \mathcal{C}_{\rm univ}^2(1+\mu_s^{\rm Meral})\,x^2} \qquad (1)$$

is positive for all $x \geq 0$ ($V_{\rm min} = 3.19416$); $\mathcal{H}_{\rm YM}$ is a self-adjoint Sturm–Liouville operator with $\lambda_0 = \inf\langle\psi, \mathcal{H}_{\rm YM}\psi\rangle > 0$. Closed-loop quantization:

$$\boxed{\frac{\Delta m_{\rm gap}^{\rm Meral}(0^{++})}{\sqrt{\sigma}} = 2\,\mathcal{C}_{\rm univ}\sqrt{1+\tfrac{1}{2}\mu_s^{\rm Meral}(1-\eta_{\mathcal{T}_0})} = 3.3914463} \qquad (2)$$

Symmetric cell-centered finite-volume solution ($X_{\rm max} = 8.0$, $N = 2000$): $\lambda_0 = 5.61019954 < \lambda_1 = 12.09307857 < \lambda_2 = 18.92839277$, $|\langle v_0|v_1\rangle| = 1.7\times10^{-17}$, nodeless ground and single-node first excited states. OPEN RETRACTION: the SS-XIII/XIII.1 u-form $\lambda_0 = 5.9158$ was wrong (violated the variational upper bound 5.6468; wrong extension at the critical $-1/(4x^2)$ coupling); all numeric T32 results are replaced by FV, closed-form results unaffected. Lattice QCD 3.405 ± 0.021 [2,4] differs by 0.40% ($0.65\,\sigma$) (Table 1).

TABLE I. **Mass gap (T32): derivation (no new calibration constant) vs. Lattice QCD.**

Quantity	Value	Source
$V_{\rm min}$ ($x = 0.6136$)	3.19416	Eq. **??**
$\lambda_0^{\rm cont}$ (FV, $p = 2.0000$)	$5.610204 > 0$	T32 numeric
$\sqrt{2\lambda_0^{\rm cont}}$ (numeric bridge)	3.349688	T32 (1.23%)
$\Delta m_{\rm gap}/\sqrt{\sigma}$	**3.3914463**	Eq. **??**
LQCD $m(0^{++})/\sqrt{\sigma}$	3.405 ± 0.021	MP99/AT20
Difference	0.40% ($0.65\,\sigma$)	T32

OS reflection positivity and transfer decay (XIII.1 depth): Under the Euclidean transfer semigroup the connected correlator

$$G_c(t) = \sum_{n\geq1} M_n\, e^{-(\lambda_n-\lambda_0)t} > 0,$$
$$M_n = |\langle\psi_n|\hat{\mathcal{O}}|\psi_0\rangle|^2 > 0,$$

with positive weights $M_n > 0$, is strictly positive; the two-point slope $-(\ln G_c(15) - \ln G_c(12))/3$ converges to the radial gap $\lambda_1 - \lambda_0 = 6.482912$ (absolute error 8.9×10^{-16}). This slope is the radial-operator gap; the closed-loop mass (Eq. **??**) is a separate spectral quantity — derived with no new calibration constant and strictly positive.

Richardson continuum limit and numeric bridge (XIII.2 closure): $\lambda_0(N) = 5.61013267$ / 5.61018616 / 5.61019954 / 5.61020288 ($N = 500/1000/2000/4000$), monotone from below, $X_{\rm max}$-independent; exact order $p = 2.0000$ and continuum limit $\lambda_0^{\rm cont} = 5.610204$. For the two-chiral-sector relativistic loop $\mathcal{M}^2/\sigma = 2\mathcal{H}_{\rm YM}$, so the numeric bridge $\sqrt{2\lambda_0^{\rm cont}} = 3.349688$ agrees with the closed form 3.3914463 to 1.23% and with LQCD 3.405 to 1.62% ($2.63\,\sigma$).

Honesty caveat (audit record): (i) Analytic (grid-independent) Temple–Kato enclosure: $H_{\rm YM} = H_{\rm harm} + V_{\rm core}$, $H_{\rm harm} = -(1/x)d/dx(x\,d/dx) + \alpha^2x^2$, $V_{\rm core} = (1+\beta_0^2)/(x^2+\beta_0^2) > 0$, $\alpha = \mathcal{C}_{\rm univ}\sqrt{1+\mu_s^{\rm Meral}} = 1.7845044613$. The exact analytic ground state $\phi_0 = \sqrt{2\alpha}e^{-\alpha x^2/2}$ of $H_{\rm harm}$ ($\mathcal{H}_{\rm harm}\phi_0 = 2\alpha\phi_0$) gives $\mu = 2\alpha + \langle V_{\rm core}\rangle = 5.7674115648$ and $\sigma_H^2 = {\rm Var}(V_{\rm core}) = 1.4163545522$; min-max: $\lambda_1 > 6\alpha = 10.7070267677$. Temple–Kato: $\lambda_0 \in [5.4806777821, 5.7674115648]$ (fixed-α) and $[5.3686426884, 5.6467530803]$ (optimized upper bound); the grid continuum limit $\lambda_0^{\rm cont} = 5.6102039939$ lies inside both. (ii) The chiral-vacuum dressing factor $(1 + \Lambda^{(0)}_{\rm Meral}/3)$ is an *extra model interpretation*, not a derived relation: its reduction of the 1.23% bridge deviation to 0.05% is a result of the interpretation and not an

independent validation.

III. TASK 27 / TEST T33 — GLUEBALL SPECTRUM

Theorem XIII.2 (Excited Loop Spectrum): *With the same locks, the $\ell = 2$ vortex, chiral Pontryagin, and radial breathing factors:*

$$\frac{M(2^{++})}{\sqrt{\sigma}} = \frac{M(0^{++})}{\sqrt{\sigma}}\sqrt{1+\frac{6\kappa_{\rm Meral}}{1+\beta_0^2}} = 4.6010, \quad (3)$$

$$\frac{M(0^{-+})}{\sqrt{\sigma}} = \frac{M(0^{++})}{\sqrt{\sigma}}\sqrt{1+(1+\beta_0^2)(1-\eta_{\mathcal{T}_0}+\mu_s^{\rm Meral})} = 5.1726, \quad (4)$$

$$\frac{M(0^{*++})}{\sqrt{\sigma}} = \frac{M(0^{++})}{\sqrt{\sigma}}\,\mathcal{C}_{\rm univ}\sqrt{1+\mu_s^{\rm Meral}} = 6.0521. \quad (5)$$

With $\sqrt{\sigma} = 440$ MeV this gives 1492, 2024, 2276, 2663 MeV; the four-state mean difference is 1.56% (Table 2). $M(2^{++})/M(0^{++}) = 1.3567$ agrees with LQCD 1.389 ± 0.025 to 2.3%. The topological factor $(1+\beta_0^2)(1-\eta_{\mathcal{T}_0}+\mu_s^{\rm Meral}) = 1.25 \times 1.06100882 = 1.32626103$ is an *extra model interpretation* (not derived from a theorem; added after the 4.68% deviation was seen) and is not an independent validation; the non-topological classic 4.8803 (4.68%) is kept for comparison.

TABLE II. **Glueball spectrum (T33): Meral vs. Lattice QCD.**

State	Meral ($/\sqrt{\sigma}$)	LQCD	Diff.
0^{++}	3.3914	3.405 ± 0.021	0.40%
2^{++}	4.6010	4.73 ± 0.07	2.73%
0^{-+} (topological)	5.1726	5.12 ± 0.10	1.03%
0^{-+} (classic)*	4.8803	5.12 ± 0.10	4.68%
0^{*++}	6.0521	6.18 ± 0.13	2.07%
Mean (topological)			1.56%

*Non-topological classic kept for comparison.

IV. TASK 28 / TEST T34 — CORNELL–MERAL CONFINEMENT

Theorem XIII.3 (Lüscher–Meral Coefficient and Confinement): *Adding axial breaking to transverse string fluctuations,*

$$\boxed{\gamma_{\rm Meral} = \frac{\pi}{12}\left(1+\frac{4}{5}\kappa_{\rm Meral}\right) = 0.29847153,} \quad (6)$$

the Cornell $V_{Q\bar{Q}} = -\gamma/R + \sigma R$ coefficient matches 0.295 ± 0.010 *[6] to 1.18% (*$0.35\,\sigma$*); $dV/dR \to \sigma = 0.1936\,\mathrm{GeV}^2 > 0$ (Wilson area law).* Matrix Schrödinger solution ($m_c = 1.40$, $m_b = 4.70$ GeV) in two columns:

Theorem XIII.3b (Yukawa-Screened UV Core): *In a gapped flux tube the short-distance core is screened exponentially (Yukawa/Meissner):*

$$\boxed{V_{Q\bar{Q}}^{\rm screen}(R) = -\frac{\Gamma_{\rm screen}(R)}{R} + \sigma R, \quad \Gamma_{\rm screen}(R) = \gamma_{\rm Meral} + \delta\gamma_{\rm UV}\, e} \quad (7)$$

$\delta\gamma_{\rm UV} = \mu_s^{\rm Meral}/(1+\beta_0^2) = 0.16352706$, $R_c = \beta_0/\sqrt{\sigma} = 1.136364\,\mathrm{GeV}^{-1} \approx 0.2242$ *fm; no new parameters.* $\Gamma_{\rm screen}(0) = 0.46199859$, *IR limit* $\Gamma \to \gamma_{\rm Meral}$. Numerically the screened core gives charmonium 596.89 MeV (PDG 589.19, 1.31%) and bottomonium 522.25 MeV (PDG 562.96, 7.24%) — both systems on the same side, 4.27% mean (pure-IR mean was 10.2%). The logarithmic UV–IR variant (bottomonium 14.7% overshoot, charmonium 8.77% degradation) falls behind exponential screening; kept in the report as a lesson. Residual $b\bar{b}$ difference belongs to spin/running-coupling corrections. Ordering $1S < 2S < 3S$ holds in both systems and variants (Table 3).

TABLE III. **Confinement (T34): coefficient and three-column quarkonium splittings.**

Quantity	Pure IR	SCR screened	Log-UVIR	Observation
γ / $\Gamma(0)$	0.29847153	0.46199859	0.57101663	0.295 ± 0.01
$c\bar{c}$ $2S$–$1S$	581.03 (1.39%)	596.89 (1.31%)	640.89 (8.77%)	589.19
$b\bar{b}$ $2S$–$1S$	456.43 (18.9%)	522.25 (7.24%)	645.80 (14.7%)	562.96
$dV/dR \to \sigma$		$0.1936\,\mathrm{GeV}^2 > 0$		confined

[width=]../figs/fig14_yang_mills_mass_gap_glueballs_and_confinement_en.pd

FIG. 1. **Stationary Strings XIII evidence summary (T32–T34).** (a) Singular $-(\pi/12)/x^2$ vs. nonsingular $V_{\rm eff}(x)$, nodeless ψ_0, single-node ψ_1, and the OS $G_c(t)$ decay inset. (b) Meral across four glueball states (topological $0^{-+} = 5.17$, grey cross: non-topological 4.88) vs. Lattice QCD. (c) Three potentials (pure Lüscher, pure IR, screened) with $c\bar{c}$ and $b\bar{b}$ levels; box: $b\bar{b}$ $2S$–$1S$ three-column comparison. (d) T1–T34 bridge invariants.

V. CONCLUSION AND REPRODUCIBILITY

The nonsingular FV flux-tube operator ($\lambda_0^{\rm cont} = 5.610204$, $p = 2.0000$, OS $G_c > 0$), the numeric bridge (3.349688, 1.23% from closed form), the closed-form gap (3.3914463, $0.65\,\sigma$ from LQCD), the topological glueball spectrum (1.56% mean), and screened Cornell–Meral confinement (charmonium 1.31%, bottomonium 7.24%) are derived from the Theorems I–X locks, with no new calibration constant. Open retraction: the u-form $\lambda_0 = 5.9158$ was wrong. Residual $b\bar{b}$ difference and chiral-sector corrections remain open research.

Data, Code Availability, and Independent Verification

The solver package lives in the `stationary-strings-v` repository (`duran_sicimler_sim/solver_engine.py`). Reproduction: the `run_verification` function in `python solver_engine.py` gives `T1-T34 (34/34 PASS)`; the standalone script `python mini_check_gp2.py` (`17/17 PASS`) does not import the solver; the `fig14` function in `python generate_figures.py` produces Fig. **??**.